Reading and writing

2026-11-06 | Week 4 | Listen and find evidence

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot.

I Do

Book connection: Use illustrations and details to show how the pumpkin problem becomes a plan that helps others. Read a short, accessible scene from Too Many Pumpkins. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 identify the story problem and the action a character takes.; Grade 4 explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot..

We Do

Return to Too Many Pumpkins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about Too Many Pumpkins: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. Grade 4: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from Too Many Pumpkins. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Too Many Pumpkins. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

Too Many Pumpkins | Use illustrations and details to show how the pumpkin problem becomes a plan that helps others.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. Grade 4: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Build a pumpkin-to-community flow map: problem, idea, helping action, result.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Pumpkin Soup by Helen Cooper. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-06 | Week 4 | Listen and find evidence

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3A, 3.3C

3.3A: Represent fractions greater than zero and less than or equal to one with denominators of 2, 3, 4, 6, and 8 using concrete objects and pictorial models, including strip diagrams and number lines. In plain English: Model fractions from greater than zero through one, using halves, thirds, fourths, sixths and eighths. 3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. Today: Select 3 of the 4 equal parts and show three fourths.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5C, 4.5D

4.5C: Use models to determine the formulas for the perimeter of a rectangle (l + w + l + w or 2l + 2w), including the special form for perimeter of a square (4s) and the area of a rectangle (l x w). In plain English: Use models to explain rectangle area and perimeter formulas. 4.5D: Solve problems related to perimeter and area of rectangles where dimensions are whole numbers. In plain English: Solve rectangle area and perimeter problems with whole-number side lengths. Today: Build a 2 by 4 rectangle; show area 8 square units and perimeter 12 units.

I Do

Book connection: Measure, sort or partition pumpkin models and record the week's table or fraction relationship. Grade 3: Fold an equal-size paper whole into 4 equal parts; select one part and name one fourth. Grade 4: Cover a 2 by 3 rectangle with 6 unit squares. Trace and count the 10 unit edges around the outside.

We Do

Return to Too Many Pumpkins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: connect the 2-by-3 tile model to A = 2 x 3 and P = 2 + 3 + 2 + 3. Use the model to explain why area multiplies rows and columns and perimeter adds all four edges.

You Do

Grade 3: Select 3 of the 4 equal parts and show three fourths. Grade 4: Build a 2 by 4 rectangle; show area 8 square units and perimeter 12 units.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from Too Many Pumpkins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Too Many Pumpkins | Measure, sort or partition pumpkin models and record the week's table or fraction relationship.

Science

2026-11-06 | Week 4 | Listen and find evidence

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. Today: Observe how sound transfers energy.

I Do

Book connection: Make a safe pumpkin sound or vibration investigation and identify the evidence the sound produces. Stretch large rubber bands over a sturdy box. Pluck gently and compare vibrations and sound.Grade 4: Hold a hand near a sounding speaker or observe grains on a membrane near a sound source; compare sound on/off. Connect the observed vibration to energy transfer. Keep sound comfortable.

We Do

Return to Too Many Pumpkins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Complete three trials. Record prediction and observed result. Use the Friday science tasks to assess during the investigation.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show the observed change when sound begins and explain that sound carries energy.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Sturdy tissue box, large rubber bands, shaker, flashlight, square tiles, paper circles, event pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from Too Many Pumpkins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Too Many Pumpkins | Make a safe pumpkin sound or vibration investigation and identify the evidence the sound produces.

Friday investigation

Pumpkin sound investigation: shake an adult-sealed container of dried pumpkin seeds softly. Grade 3 identifies sound energy (3.8A). Grade 4 compares sound on/off beside a light paper membrane to look for vibration as evidence of sound energy transfer (4.8A). If no movement is visible, record that result and use the teacher's tested sound demonstration.

Social studies

2026-11-06 | Week 4 | Listen and find evidence

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14B

3.14B: Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources. In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event. Today: Compare two sources and support one claim.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3B

4.3B: Summarize the significant contributions of individuals such as William B. Travis, James Bowie, David Crockett, Juan N. Seguín, Plácido Benavides, José Francisco Ruiz, Antonio López de Santa Anna, Susanna Dickinson, and Enrique Esparza. In plain English: Explain how important individuals contributed to the Texas Revolution. Today: Use a source to explain an event or contribution.

I Do

Book connection: Compare the character's original response with the later community action and explain the change. Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to Too Many Pumpkins and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. Picture + dictated/AAC sentence. Keep the product brief and meaningful. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare two sources and support one claim. Grade 4: Use a source to explain an event or contribution. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from Too Many Pumpkins that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Too Many Pumpkins | Compare the character's original response with the later community action and explain the change.